Create your first visualization

Activity · Visualizations & Interpretation · ~15 min

BEFORE YOU START

- ◻ You're signed in and looking at your country's project
- ◻ You're in the **Visualizations** tab
- ◻ You have a folder of your own (or you can use the shared one)

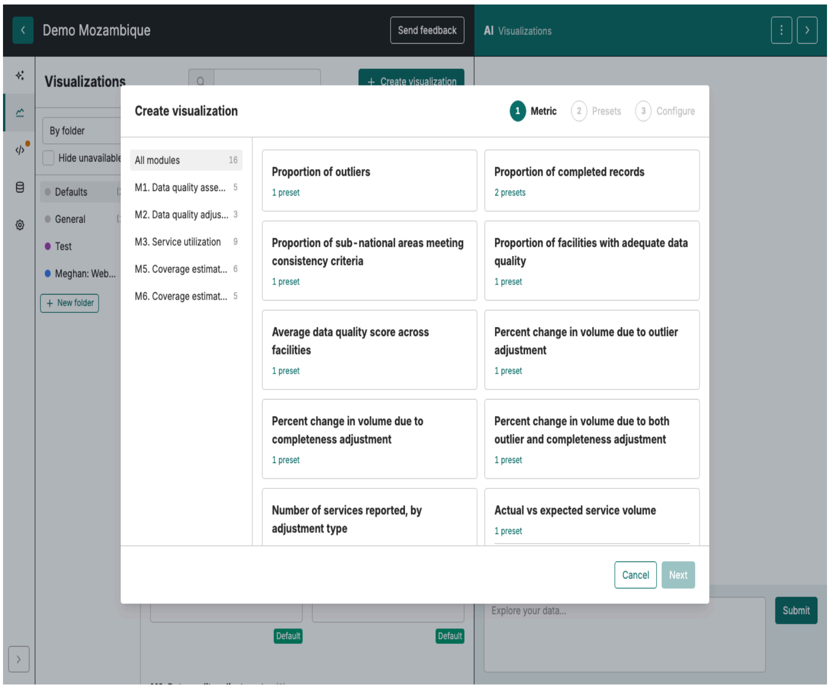
What you'll do

Build three time-series charts: first **ANC1**, then **BCG**, then **one indicator of your choice**. Each chart is saved into your folder in the project's Visualizations list. The next activity does the same task with the AI Assistant.

1 Open the Create visualization dialog

In the **Visualizations** tab, click the green **+ Create visualization** button in the top right.

A three-step dialog opens: **Metric → Presets → Configure**.



2 Pick a metric

In the left panel of the dialog, click **M3. Service utilization**. The grid on the right now lists only M3 metrics.

Click the tile **Number of services reported, by adjustment type**.

Click **Next** at the bottom right.

> Metrics are grouped by module: **M1** (Data quality assessment), **M2** (Data quality adjustment), **M3** (Service utilization), **M5** (Coverage — denominators), **M6** (Coverage — estimates). There is no M4. A metric is *what is measured*. A preset is *one ready-made way to draw it*.

3 Pick a preset

You're now on the **Presets** step. Click **Service volume over time (monthly)** — a line chart of monthly volume.

The chart opens in the editor.

4 Filter to ANC1, last 12 months

The chart opens with all indicators shown across the full available time period. You'll narrow it to **ANC1, last 12 months**.

In the chart editor's **left panel**, scroll down to **Filter (subset)**:

- Under **Indicators**, tick **ANC1** only (untick the rest, or use the search box).
- Under **Time period**, set the range to the **last 12 months**.

The chart updates as you tick.

5 Save it to your folder

Click **Save as new viz** at the top of the editor. Give it a clear name (e.g. *ANC1 — monthly, last 12 months*) and save it into **your folder**.

It now appears in the Visualizations list under your folder.

Now do it twice more

Repeat the same five steps for:

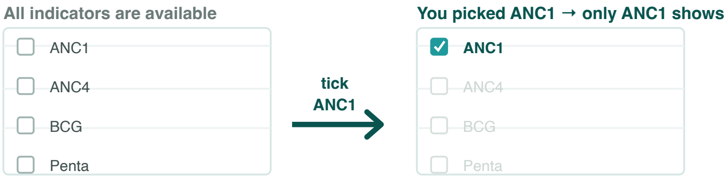
1. **BCG** — same path, but tick **BCG** at Step 4 instead of ANC1.
2. **An indicator of your choice** — anything that interests you (Penta1, ANC4, IPD admissions…).

Filter vs disaggregate — what's the difference?

These two words come up a lot. They are not the same:

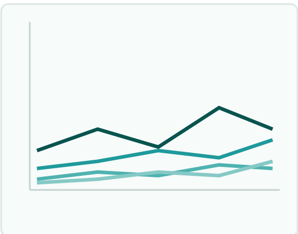
- **Filter = pick what to show.** Choose the indicators, places, or months you want — only those appear. e.g. *show ANC1 only*, or *Northern region only*. Like a spotlight: you point it at what you want to see.
- **Disaggregate = break it down.** Split one total into its parts so you can compare them — e.g. *one line per indicator*, or *one bar per district*. Nothing is hidden; the total is shown as its pieces.

FILTER = choose what to show

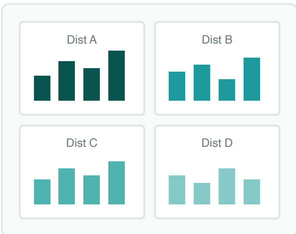


You pick what you want to see.
Whatever you don't tick simply isn't shown — like a spotlight.

DISAGGREGATE "ANC1 by district" — four ways to display the parts



Lines
one line per district



Grid
a mini chart for each

District	Visits
Dist A	900
Dist B	850
Dist C	1,000
Dist D	800

Rows
one row per district

Dist A	Dist B	Dist C	Dist D
900	850	1,000	800

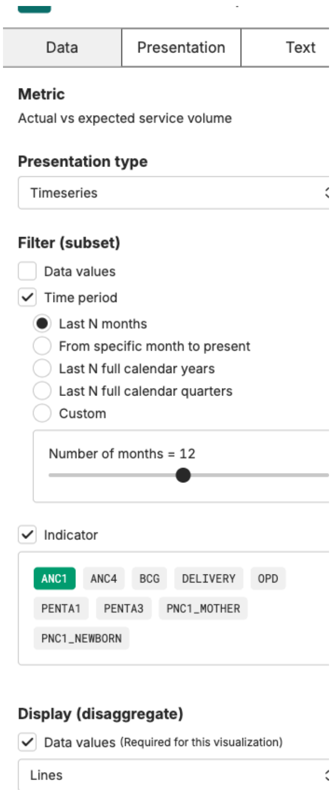
Columns
one column per district

> **Example.** Start with *total ANC1 visits, nationally*. **Filter** to "Northern region" → now you see only Northern's ANC1. **Disaggregate** "by district" → the same total split into one bar (or line) per district.

Where you do this when you edit a viz

Open a saved visualization — the controls live in the **left panel**, and you'll often need to **scroll down** to find them (this is where people get lost). Two sections do the work:

- **Filter (subset)** — **pick what you want to see**: set the time period, and tick the indicator(s) you want. Only what you tick appears.
- **Display (disaggregate)** — choose **how the parts are shown**. The dropdown gives four options:
  - **Lines** — one line per part, all on the same chart
  - **Grid** — a separate little chart for each part, side by side
  - **Rows** — one table row per part
  - **Columns** — one table column per part



Watch out when you use both together. Here's the trap, with an example. You split a chart **by district** because you want to compare the districts. Then you **filter** it down to just one district — so the others disappear. Now you're looking at a single district on its own, and there's nothing left to compare.

The simple rule: use **filter** to pick the data you want to look at, and use **disaggregate** to split it into the parts you want to compare. Just don't filter down to only one of the things you wanted to compare.

Exercise: split your ANC1 chart by region

Right now your ANC1 chart shows one line: the national total over the last 12 months. You'll turn it into one line per **region** so you can compare regions side by side.

1 Open the chart

In the **Visualizations** list, open your saved ANC1 chart (the one you named *ANC1 — monthly, last 12 months*).

2 Disaggregate by region

In the chart editor's **left panel**, scroll down to **Display (disaggregate)**.

- Set the dimension to **Region** (the dropdown that asks *what to break the chart down by*).
- Leave the Display style on **Lines** for now — one line per region, all on the same chart.

The chart redraws. Instead of one national line, you should now see **one line per region**.

3 Try the other Display styles

Same data, different shape:

- **Grid** — a separate little chart per region, side by side. Useful when there are many regions and the lines overlap.
- **Rows** — a table with one row per region. Useful when you want the exact values rather than the shape.
- **Columns** — a table with one column per region.

Pick whichever reads best for your data.

4 Save it as a new chart

Click **Save as new viz** — name it e.g. *ANC1 — monthly, by region* and save it into **your folder**.

> **Don't overwrite the national chart.** Save *as new viz*, not just *save*, so you keep both: the national trend and the regional split.

Watch out

You set both Filter and Display in step 2 of the original walkthrough (filter to ANC1, last 12 months) and step 2 of this exercise (disaggregate by region). That's fine. The trap is **filtering down to one of the things you said you wanted to compare** — e.g. disaggregate by region *and then* filter to a single region. You'd be left with one line, nothing to compare.

Try a few more options

Once your three charts are saved, try a different metric or preset:

- A coverage metric under **M6** (a coverage curve, not a volume trend).
- The quarterly-change bar chart preset (compares periods instead of plotting a continuous trend).

> **Tip:** Line charts (*Service volume over time*) are best for trends over time. Bar charts (*quarterly / annual change*) are better for comparing periods or places. The reference handout *How to read a FASTR visualization* goes deeper.

Check yourself

You should now have:

- **Three saved charts** in your folder: ANC1, BCG, and one of your choice.
- The path memorised: **+ Create visualization → M3 → metric → preset → filter → Save as new viz**.
- A sense of which presets suit trends vs comparisons.

What's next

The next activity does the same thing using the AI Assistant — typing the request in plain language instead of clicking through the dialog. Same end result, different path.